

Vocal Profile Suggestions: Count Orlok

ElevenLabs Configuration & Animatronic Integration Notes

Research & Methodology

The suggestions for this vocal profile were derived from analyzing critical reception and available behind-the-scenes insights into Bill Skarsgård's performance in the 2024 film *Nosferatu*. Rather than relying on digital modulation, the actor achieved the character's voice through intense physical vocal mechanics.

Key findings that informed these recommendations include:

- **Vocal Training:** Insights into the actor's work with an Icelandic opera singer to fundamentally drop his speaking voice by a full octave, anchoring the sound deep in the chest.
- **Technique:** The incorporation of Mongolian throat singing exercises to maintain an active, rumbling subharmonic texture beneath the primary pitch.
- **Delivery Analysis:** Observational reviews of his cadence, often described as a hypnotic, "weakly singing" drawl that abandons standard conversational pacing in favor of prolonged, agonizing vowels.

Suggested ElevenLabs Configuration

When setting up a Voice Design profile or feeding a system prompt to a Conversational Agent, you might find that the following description yields a close approximation of the character's unique tone:

"An ancient, monstrous male voice with a thick, archaic Eastern European accent. The pitch is exceptionally low and heavily resonant, dropped a full octave into the chest. The voice features guttural, rumbling overtones similar to Mongolian throat singing. He speaks with a slow, hypnotic, and strained cadence—as if he is weakly

singing his words with prolonged vowels rather than speaking them normally. The tone is gravelly, haunting, and physically exhausted yet deeply intimidating."

To further refine the output, consider adjusting the following settings in ElevenLabs:

- **Stability (Suggested: 25-35%):** Keeping this slider relatively low can introduce slight fluctuations and vocal cracks. This helps capture the physically strained, ancient quality without sounding like a flat, polished broadcast announcer.
- **Style Exaggeration (Suggested: 60-70%):** Pushing this setting up encourages the AI to lean more heavily into the guttural accent and throat-singing overtones.
- **Text Formatting:** Using frequent ellipses (...) and em dashes (—) can naturally encourage the AI to take longer pauses. Phonetically spelling out elongated vowels (e.g., "Cooome tooo meee...") may also help replicate the desired musicality and pacing.

Hardware Integration Notes

The deliberate, drawn-out pacing of this specific vocal profile can actually be quite advantageous for hardware synchronization.

Because the character slowly rolls his syllables, the elongated, musical vowels can be mapped cleanly to the distinct open and close states of a square-mouth marionette mechanism. This slower, sustained audio pipeline provides high-torque servos with ample time to hit their target positions, which may help minimize the servo jitter that frequently occurs when attempting to animate fast, conversational speech within a MonsterBox application framework.